

Type of Intervention: Individual

Domain: Socioemotional

Student/Adult Name (if applicable): H.T.

Number of Students (if applicable): 1

Grade of student(s) being worked with or discussed: 4th grade

What was the reason for the intervention?

A student came to the counseling room before school for an individual check-in to process emotions experienced due to her dog dying recently.

Provide a brief summary of the intervention:

I took the student to the Cub Corner (sensory room) to have an individual check-in. The student said that two weeks ago, her dog had to be put down at the vet because she was very old. She stated that she didn't get the chance to say goodbye to her dog because she was at her grandparents' house for the weekend with her brothers. She said she was having trouble with her emotions and that every time she thought of her dog, she would get very sad and cry, distracting her from her work. She also said that she was struggling with seeing her dad crying over the loss, and she felt that she was unable to go to him for comfort. She stated her father had also just had surgery over the weekend and needed to rest, so she was unable to physically access him as well. We discussed her relationship with her dog and how important the dog was to the family. We also discussed how, when she had thoughts of her dog, she could focus on happy memories that she had with her and reframe her thoughts to focus on those and how they made her happy. We also discussed things that were coming up for her that she was looking forward to (going to The Fox, spring break trip, etc.).

Describe what went well:

The student was able to practice reframing some of the thoughts she was having about her dog, enabling her to smile and laugh about her memories instead of crying. She was able to discuss ways that she could speak to her parents about how she was feeling, even if they seemed sad about the situation as well. The student was also able to open up and discuss positive things she was looking forward to, distracting herself from the negative thoughts she was having at the beginning of the session.

Describe what you would like to work on after reflecting on this intervention:

I would like to work on more strategies for dealing with grief to help students handle the emotions and grief process. I would also like to develop further skills in reframing and CBT skills that could be beneficial with students during check-ins.

What is your plan for follow up with the student(s), family member, or staff member?

The student and I made a plan to have another check-in the following week, after she had a chance to use the reframing skills and speak with her family. We also planned for how she could handle the emotions on her own as she experienced them, discussing how it was okay to cry and feel sad, but how we could turn those feelings into positive thoughts based on her pleasant memories.

What questions do you have for the supervision group?

- What has been a helpful strategy you have used with students who are dealing with grief?
- Are there any activities you think will be helpful moving forward with this student?